EXPENSES[1]

($m)	1st Half 2026	1st Half 2025	% chg	2nd Half 2025	% chg
Staff	**3,065**	2,909	5	2,923	5
Occupancy	**205**	214	(4)	245	(16)
Computerisation	**642**	640	0	720	(11)
Revenue-related	**305**	276	11	336	(9)
Others	**432**	445	(3)	541	(20)
Total	**4,649**	4,484	4	4,765	(2)
Staff count[2] at period-end	**39,892**	40,187	(1)	39,721	0
Included in the above table was:					
Depreciation of properties and other fixed assets	**411**	410	0	414	(1)

Notes:
1 Excludes impact arising from Provision for CSR
2 Measured based on full-time equivalent

First-half expenses increased 4% from a year ago to $4.65 billion, led by higher staff costs. Non-staff costs also rose from higher revenue-related expenses.

Compared to the previous half-year, expenses declined 2% from lower non-staff costs.

The cost-income ratio was 39%, stable from a year ago and three percentage points lower than the previous half-year.

ALLOWANCES FOR CREDIT AND OTHER LOSSES

($m)	1st Half 2026	1st Half 2025	% chg	2nd Half 2025	% chg
ECL Stage 1 and 2 (GP)	**(42)**	188	NM	(251)	83
ECL Stage 3 (SP) for loans[1]	**336**	267	26	575	(42)
Singapore	**112**	(39)	NM	197	(43)
Hong Kong	**85**	60	42	267	(68)
Rest of Greater China	**69**	46	50	59	17
South and Southeast Asia	**59**	62	(5)	57	4
Rest of the World	**11**	138	(92)	(5)	NM
ECL Stage 3 (SP) for other credit exposures	**9**	(7)	NM	10	(10)
Total ECL Stage 3 (SP)	**345**	260	33	585	(41)
Allowances for other assets	**-**	10	(100)	(1)	NM
Total	**303**	458	(34)	333	(9)

Notes:
1 SP for loans by geography are determined according to the location where the borrower is incorporated
NM Not Meaningful

First-half specific allowances for loans of $336 million were higher than a year ago but, at 15 basis points of loans, remained below the historical cycle average. Compared to the previous half-year, they were 42% lower.

General allowances of $42 million were written back in the first half, compared to a charge of $188 million a year ago and a writeback of $251 million in the previous half-year.

Total allowances amounted to $303 million, 34% lower than a year ago and 9% below the previous half-year.